“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 12

The Branches of Śrī Advaita’s Trunk

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Among all the bees at Advaita’s lotus feet, some hold to the essence and some to the chaff. Rejecting those who hold the chaff, I praise those who hold the essence, whose very life is Caitanya.

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to the blessed Advaita!

3 We bow to the followers of Śrīmad Advaitacandra, the second trunk of the immortal tree that is Śrī Caitanya; they are its branches.

4 The second trunk of the tree is Ācārya Gosāñi. The branches that grew from Him are beyond counting.

5 Sprinkled with the water of mercy by Caitanya the gardener, the trunk is nourished by that water and grows day by day.

6 The fruits of love that grew on that trunk—fruits of love for Kṛṣṇa—filled the world.

7 The trunk passes that water on to the branches; laden with fruits and flowers, they grow and spread far and wide.

8 At first the Ācārya's followers were of one mind; later, by the turn of fate, they split into two views.

9 Some kept to the Ācārya's order; others became independent and, under the sway of fate (*daiva*), invented views of their own.

10 The Ācārya's view is the essence. Whoever transgresses His order is worthless.

11 There is no need here to name the worthless. I count them all together only so that the difference may be known.

12 It is like measuring a heap of paddy together with its husks and afterwards winnowing the husks away to clean it.

13 Acyutānanda, the Ācārya's son, is a great branch. From birth he served the feet of Caitanya.

14 Hearing his father say that Keśava Bhāratī was the guru of Caitanya Gosāñi, he was deeply pained.

15 "You give such teaching about the guru of the world! By this teaching of Yours the land is ruined.

16 Caitanya Gosāñi is the guru of the fourteen worlds. No scripture says that anyone else is His guru."

17 Hearing a boy in his fifth year speak the essence of the scriptural conclusions, the Ācārya was boundlessly pleased.

18 Another son of the Ācārya is named Kṛṣṇa Miśra; Caitanya Gosāñi dwells in his heart.

19 Another son of the Ācārya is named Śrī Gopāla. Hear of his conduct—it is most wonderful.

20 In the Guṇḍicā temple, before Mahāprabhu, he danced in the kīrtana in the great joy of love.

21 Many ecstasies arose in his body, and his dancing was wonderful; the two Gosāñis, joyful at heart, called out “Hari!”

22 As he danced on and on, Gopāla fainted and fell to the ground; no awareness was left in his body.

23 Grieved, the Ācārya took His son on His lap and sought to protect him by reciting the mantra of Nṛsiṁha.

24 The Ācārya recited many mantras, but Gopāla did not come to. Seeing the Ācārya’s grief, the Vaiṣṇavas wept.

25 Then Mahāprabhu placed His hand on Gopāla’s chest and said, “Get up, Gopāla! Say ‘Hari’! Say ‘Hari’!”

26 At the Lord’s touch and voice Gopāla rose, and everyone, overjoyed, called out the name of Hari.

27 Another son of the Ācārya is Śrī Balarāma; another son is the branch Svarūpa; another is named Jagadīśa.

28 The Ācārya had a servant named Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, who knew all the Ācārya’s affairs.

29 In Nīlācala he wrote a letter and sent it to Pratāparudra.

30 The Ācārya knew nothing of that letter, but by some turn of events it reached the Lord.

31 What was written in the letter was this: it declared the Ācārya to be the Lord Himself,

32 “but by fate He has fallen into some debt; to clear it, I ask for three hundred rupees.”

33 Reading the letter, the Lord was pained at heart, but outwardly the moon-faced Lord smiled and said:

34 “He has declared the Ācārya to be the Lord. There is no fault in that: the Ācārya is indeed the divine Lord.

35 But he has made the Lord out to be poor and has begged on His behalf. So I will punish him and teach him a lesson.”

36 He ordered Govinda, “From today, do not let this madcap (*bāuliyā*) Viśvāsa come here.”

37 Hearing of the punishment, Viśvāsa was deeply grieved; but the Ācārya, hearing of the Lord’s punishment, was delighted.

38 He said to Viśvāsa, “You are most fortunate: the Lord, Bhagavān Himself, has punished you.

39 Formerly Mahāprabhu treated Me with respect. That pained Me, and I thought of a plan.

40 I expounded the *Vāsiṣṭha*, declaring liberation the highest, and the Lord grew angry and dishonored Me.

41 Receiving that punishment, I felt supreme joy—the same punishment that the fortunate Śrī Mukunda received.

42 The punishment that the fortunate Śrī Śacī received—where can anyone else find such grace in punishment?”

43 Having comforted him with these words, the Ācārya joyfully went to Mahāprabhu.

44 He said to the Lord, “I do not understand this pastime of Yours. You have made Kamalā a greater object of Your grace than Me.

45 Such grace You have never shown even to Me. What offense have I committed at Your feet?”

46 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu began to laugh. He called Kamalākānta and was pleased with him.

47 The Ācārya said, “Why have You let him see You? He has made a mockery of Me in two ways.”

48 Hearing this, the Lord was pleased at heart. Each of Them knew the other’s inner meaning.

49 The Lord said, “*Bāuliyā*, why do you act like this? What you do brings the Ācārya disgrace and harms His dharma.

50 He must never accept a king’s wealth. When one eats the food of worldly people, the mind becomes defiled.

51 When the mind is defiled, one cannot remember Kṛṣṇa, and without remembrance of Kṛṣṇa, life is fruitless.

52 One is shamed before people, and one's dharma and good name are lost. Knowing this, never do such a thing."

53 This teaching was meant for everyone, and everyone took it to heart. Ācārya Gosāñi felt joy within.

54 Only the Lord understands the Ācārya's intention, and only the Ācārya grasps the Lord's deep words.

55 There is much to consider in this matter, but I fear making the book too long, so I cannot write it out.

56 Śrī Yadunandanācārya is a branch of Advaita. His branches and sub-branches are beyond counting.

57 He is the recipient of Vāsudeva Datta's mercy and has taken shelter at Caitanya's feet in every way.

58 Bhāgavatācārya, Viṣṇudāsācārya, Cakrapāṇi Ācārya, Ananta Ācārya,

59 Nandinī, Kāmadeva, Caitanya dāsa, Durlabha Viśvāsa, Vanamāli dāsa,

60 Jagannātha Kara, Bhavanātha Kara, Hṛdayānanda Sena, Bholānātha dāsa,

61 Yādava dāsa, Vijaya dāsa, Janārdana dāsa, Ananta dāsa, Kānu Paṇḍita, Nārāyaṇa dāsa,

62 Śrīvatsa Paṇḍita, Haridāsa Brahmacārī, Puruṣottama Brahmacārī, Kṛṣṇadāsa,

63 Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, Raghunātha, Vanamālī Kavicandra, Vaidyanātha,

64 Lokanātha Paṇḍita, Murāri Paṇḍita, Śrī Haricaraṇa, Mādhava Paṇḍita,

65 Vijaya Paṇḍita and Paṇḍita Śrīrāma. Advaita's branches are countless—how many names can I give?

66 The Advaita trunk supplies the water that the gardener gives; by that water the branches live and bear flowers and fruits.

67 Among them, after the gardener's departure, some branches, through misfortune, did not accept Caitanya the gardener.

68 He had made them grow and kept them alive, yet they did not accept Him. They became ungrateful, and the trunk grew angry with them.

69 In its anger the trunk passes them no water, and for lack of water the branch withers, dries up and dies.

70 A body without Caitanya—without consciousness—is like dry wood. Such a person is dead while still alive, and when he dies, Yama punishes him.

71 This punishment is not for this group alone: whoever turns away from Caitanya is a *pāṣaṇḍa*, an unbeliever.

72 Be he a scholar, an ascetic, a householder or a renunciant—whoever turns away from Caitanya meets this end.

73 Those of the Ācārya's followers who took Śrī Acyutānanda's view are great devotees.

74 Each of them received the Ācārya's mercy and easily attained the feet of Caitanya.

75 To those followers of the Ācārya I offer millions of obeisances; like Acyutānanda, they have Caitanya as their life.

76 Thus I have told of Ācārya Gosāñi's followers; I have given a brief count of the branches of the three trunks.

77 The sub-branches of these branches are beyond counting; telling only a little, I give an indication.

78 The sub-branches of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita are most excellent; I shall count some of them.

79 Foremost among the branches are Dhruvānanda, Śrīdhara Brahmacārī, Bhāgavatācārya, Haridāsa Brahmacārī,

80 Ananta Ācārya, Kavidatta, Nayana Miśra, Gaṅgāmantrī, Māmu Ṭhākura, Kaṇṭhābharaṇa,

81 Bhūgarbha Gosāñi and Bhāgavata dāsa, who both came to live in Vṛndāvana,

82 the great soul Vāṇīnātha Brahmacārī, Vallabha Caitanya dāsa, full of love for Kṛṣṇa,

83 Śrīnātha Cakravartī, Uddhava dāsa, Jitāmitra, Jagannātha dāsa the woodcutter (*kāṣṭhakāṭā*),

84 Śrī Hari Ācārya, Puriyā-gopāla dāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī, Puṣpagopāla,

85 Śrīharṣa, Raghu Miśra, Paṇḍita Lakṣmīnātha, Caitanya dāsa of Baṅgavāṭī, Śrī Raghunātha,

86 Amogha Paṇḍita, Hastigopāla, Caitanya-vallabha, Yadu Gāṅguli and Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava.

87 Śivānanda Cakravartī stands high among the branches; his resting place is the feet of Madana-gopāla.

88 Thus I have briefly told of the Paṇḍita's followers; the other branches and sub-branches are to be counted in the same way.

89 All the Paṇḍita's followers are blessed devotees, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the beloved of their lives.

90 I have counted the branches of these three trunks; by remembering them all, one is released from the bondage of worldly existence.

91 By remembering them all we attain Caitanya's feet; by remembering them all our desires are fulfilled.

92 Therefore I worship the feet of them all, and now I tell in order the pastimes of Caitanya the gardener.

93 The nectar ocean of Gaura's pastimes is shoreless and fathomless. Who could even wish to plunge into it?

94 Yet my mind is enticed by the fragrance of its sweetness, so, standing on the shore, I taste a single drop.

95 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.